

Research Statement

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In this document, I share about research philosophy, my research group Translate, research themes and topics of work, publications and translation efforts since I have joined Pratt in Fall 2023, and future research agenda.

Overview and Philosophy

I am a critical qualitative and a design researcher. My focus lies at the intersection of design, Human-Computer Interaction (HCI), design practice and pedagogy, and ethics & values, which I seek to investigate largely through design research and critical qualitative research methods. I take a practice-led approach in learning, investigating, developing, and disseminating for design ethics as it happens on the ground, *in situ*, and ecologically mediated. I take a pragmatist ethics lens to investigate ethics and values in HCI practice and design to describe ethical awareness of technology practitioners, foreground impacts on users (society), and design supports for ethical action in design for both designers and educators. I explore a research topic from multiple perspectives building on data triangulation that helps describe the research landscape, leading towards design-oriented outcomes. I am to share and publish these design-oriented outcomes, in the form of methods or pedagogical tools, as open-access for student designers, practitioners, and educators (e.g., using platforms like Miroverse). I have built expertise in a range of data collection methods including semi-structured and structured interviews, observations, lab protocol studies, digital ethnography, surveys, research through design, and co-design methodology. I also utilize a range of data analysis procedures including reflective, thematic, content, discourse, sequence, and visual content analysis.

I have published my research in top-tier venues in HCI and design, such as the ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), Journal of Responsible Computing (JRC), Designing Interactive Systems (DIS), Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW), Interactions, and EduCHI. Till date I have published: one Book, 16 references conference proceedings, 7 journal papers, one book chapter, 8 extended abstracts, 4 websites with disseminated research artifacts, 5 manuscripts in arXiv or making, and two grant proposals.

Themes of Research Work at Translate Research Group

I have established a research group named [TRANSLATE](#) ✎ in Spring 2024. At the *Translate* research group, we delve into the ethical dimensions of technology and design practices. We *translate* (intentionally named as a “verb”) these investigations into practical resources to support ethical decision-making, offering methods for reflecting on ethical responsibility and actionable tools for

ethical reflection. Since 2024, the group has grown to have 3 Pratt GAs and 5 external **collaborators** to conduct research and produce translatable research and pedagogical artifacts.

At Translate, we conduct research across these three broad areas:

- Ethics in HCI and Design Practice ✍
- Tech Regulation and Policy ✍
- Design (Ethics) Pedagogy and Methods ✍

In the next sections, I present particular (ongoing and wrapped up) projects and publications within these broad research areas.

Ethics in HCI and Design Practice

In this theme, we engage in describing *perspectives of a practitioner* as an individual in the negotiation of user and stakeholder values, ecological mediation ([Chivukula and Gray 2024](#)), and disciplinary framing of ethics; describing vocabulary of ethics in practice ([Gray et al. 2023](#); [Chivukula et al. 2023](#)); computational and different ways of representing and analyzing ethical action ([Chivukula and Gray 2024](#)); tracing practitioner concepts of ethics as discussed on professional platforms or social media ([Obi et al. 2025](#)); and ongoing work includes describing “constellations of disciplinary values” of a range of socio-technical professional roles engage in values in their everyday work^[MANUSCRIPT IN MAKING].

[MANUSCRIPT IN MAKING] [Chivukula, S. S., Gray, C. M., Pivonka, A., & Will, M \(n.d.\)](#). Value Constellations across Technology and Design Professional Roles. Potential submission to Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (TOCHI).

Tech Regulation and Policy

In this theme, we investigate current tech regulation and policy knowledge that exists for ethical design for practice and education; identifying practitioner opinions and engagement with legal or regulatory knowledge as a part of their everyday practice; and translating regulatory knowledge and vocabulary into design vocabulary for technology and design practitioners to better embed tech regulation into everyday design work (also related to theme Design (Ethics) Pedagogy and Methods ✍). Couple of efforts under this theme:

NSF Grant Proposal. I have co-authored and submitted a NSF HCC: Small grant in December 2024, where Pratt is a sub-awardee, titled “*Wrangling Legal and Design Knowledge in UX Practice.*” We have received positive reviews with rejection and re-submitting for NSF: CISE-Future Computing Research track ✍ as a Co-PI to share \$1M across 4 years in Sept 2025. This grant proposal explores how UX practitioners manage the growing complexity of integrating social, technical, business, and legal knowledge in digital system design. With increasing regulatory pressures and ethical concerns, the study aims to model practitioner competencies ([Gray et al. 2024](#)), document

organizational practices, and create new support structures. Using interviews, surveys, and Research through Design, the project will generate actionable insights and frameworks to inform industry, education, and policy, fostering more ethical, compliant, and resilient UX and HCI practices.

Project 1: Technology–Regulation Curriculum Mapping [ONGOING]. This project investigates how U.S. tech, information, and design curricula address ethics and regulation, particularly in response to growing concerns around digital manipulation and policy like GDPR and FTC actions. Through curriculum analysis, it aims to map existing gaps, inform educational strategies, and develop accessible resources for educators and institutions. This work has been an ongoing collaboration with researchers from Georgia Tech University and University of Sydney, *outcomes* being a research manuscript to be submitted to Journal of Responsible Computing or ICER: ACM International Computing Education Research and open-access collection of the documented courses as a repository for educators to teach at the intersection of Information and Regulation.

Project 2: Translating Legal Vocabulary into Design Vocabulary–Worksheets [ONGOING]. This project explores a new trajectory of my research at the intersection of tech regulation, UX design, and legal knowledge, where we are designing practical ways to include legal or regulatory knowledge for UX designers as a part of the Regulation–Informed Design project. While investigating various ways regulatory knowledge can be translated into a UX design process—employing design research techniques—*outcomes* from this project are detailed worksheets (Open-Access through Miroverse) that can be used as design methods and pedagogical tools.

Design (Ethics) Pedagogy and Methods

While studying ethical dimensions of design practice (Theme 1) and ways of translating tech regulation and policy-based dimensions for and into design practice (Theme 2), I focus majorly on practical ways of building design practice through methods and pedagogical tools for educators. I extensively surveyed and described ways to define ethics-focused methods ([Chivukula et al. 2024](#)), which is used as a foundation for my research under this theme.

[Book] Universal Methods of Ethical Design. I have co-authored and published a book titled “[Universal Methods of Ethical Design](#)” in 2024, which is launched in April 2025. The book provides 100 Ways to Become More Ethically Aware, Responsible, and Active in Your Design Work. This book is being proposed to be included as course material in different design programs and will also be translated globally as a part of Rockport Universal Series. The titles in the Rockport Universal series offer comprehensive and authoritative information and edifying and inspiring visual examples on multidisciplinary subjects for designers, architects, engineers, students, and anyone who is interested in expanding and enriching their design knowledge. This book has

been suggested to be included as course material in various information and design-related programs all over the US and being translated into various languages across the world.

Project 1. Anti-Heroes project ✂ Anti-Hero card deck is designed to navigate the difficult conflicts between manipulative tendencies and value-centered roles ([Chivukula et al. 2025](#)), allowing it to be a catalyst to incite meaningful design conversations and decision making. More than 200 card decks have been disseminated ✂ during conferences, through professional networks, via Pratt K-12 outreach programs, and HCI/design educators in both digital and physical formats. We have expanded the card deck as a way to activate the card deck in various stages of a design process, emphasize a sense of balance between monetary and user values, and embed design practices from industries to build practice resonance ([Chivukula et al. 2025](#)). **Outcomes:** these carefully crafted activities are published on Miroverse ✂ for free public access to designers and educators which have- 600+ views and 20+ template uses in 4 months of posting. We plan to work more on advertising these research artifacts in the future in conferences and practitioner-heavy platforms. I also use these research artifacts as part of my pedagogical tools to translate my research into teaching in classrooms. This project has also resulted in two full conference papers (published in Designing Interactive Systems (DIS) and EduCHI) and three poster presentations.

Project 2. Value Lanes [ONGOING] ✂ is a dialogue-focused toolkit for design teams and product thinkers who want to sharpen how they argue, persuade, and make value-centered decisions together. The toolkit is designed employing game dynamics and primarily to be used as a pedagogical tool by educators as a skill building support for ethical argumentation. Each kind of play will challenge you to speak and present your argument from different perspectives—user, business, technical, legal, or personal—and navigate complex design trade-offs. Just like, picking a lane or sometimes, multiple! It's fast, collaborative, and helps teams practice saying the quiet parts out loud. **Outcomes** from this project are anticipated to be a physical game deck to share with HCI/d program directors and design educators as a pedagogical tool, workshops to employ the game deck, and research articles from the evaluation studies and design research process.

In the future, I wish to continue, develop, and build on the [ONGOING] projects (identified above) to support Translate's research goals. I aim to regularly publish in research venues and engage with scholarly publications as a form of disseminating translatable material into design practice and pedagogy.